Enema Kit

Category: **Medical, Healthcare & First Aid** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Enema can be done with tubing

What it is used for

An enema kit is used to introduce a prescribed liquid into the rectum through tubing for a specific clinical purpose. It must be used only under appropriate clinical direction, with correct patient assessment, hygienic equipment handling, and careful monitoring to reduce the risk of injury, infection, and fluid-related complications.

Main parts

- Enema container or prescribed solution bag
- Tubing and flow-control clamp
- Patient-end nozzle or rectal tip
- Connector and seal components
- Support hook or stand, where supplied
- Prescribed solution, gloves, lubricant, and waste supplies

Before you start

1. Use an enema kit only when prescribed or specifically advised by an authorised healthcare professional and when trained to perform the procedure.
2. Verify the patient's identity, prescribed solution, intended volume, route, and relevant allergies or contraindications.
3. Assess for warning symptoms or conditions requiring clinical review, such as severe abdominal pain, rectal bleeding, suspected bowel obstruction, or recent relevant surgery.
4. Check the kit packaging, expiry date where applicable, tubing, clamp, connectors, and nozzle for damage or contamination.
5. Prepare the prescribed solution at the specified temperature and concentration; do not substitute solutions or add medicines without authorisation.
6. Provide privacy, explain the procedure, obtain consent, perform hand hygiene, and wear appropriate gloves and protective clothing.

How to use

1. Prepare a clean working area and place suitable absorbent protection beneath the patient as needed.
2. Assemble the kit according to its instructions and confirm that the tubing and nozzle are correctly connected.
3. Fill the container only with the prescribed solution and specified volume, avoiding contamination.
4. Close the clamp and prime the tubing as directed to remove trapped air before use.

5. Position the patient according to the clinician's instructions, commonly on the left side with knees comfortably bent if appropriate.
6. Apply a suitable water-soluble lubricant to the nozzle if instructed by the approved procedure.
7. Explain each step and insert the nozzle gently only as directed by the clinical protocol; never force it against resistance.
8. Open the clamp gradually and administer the solution at the prescribed rate while monitoring the patient's comfort and response.
9. Stop the flow immediately if the patient develops significant pain, bleeding, dizziness, distress, or unexpected resistance.
10. Do not increase pressure, force the solution, or continue beyond the prescribed volume or clinical instructions.
11. After administration, follow the prescribed retention and toileting instructions and provide assistance as needed.
12. Dispose of single-use components safely and clean reusable components only if they are specifically designed for reuse and approved for that purpose.
13. Perform hand hygiene, document the solution, volume, time, patient response, and any complications, and report concerns to the responsible clinician.

⚠ Safety

- This procedure should be performed only under appropriate clinical direction by trained personnel or by a patient who has been specifically instructed by a healthcare professional.
- Do not use an enema when contraindicated or when severe abdominal pain, unexplained rectal bleeding, suspected obstruction, or another urgent warning sign requires medical assessment.
- Never force the nozzle or solution against resistance; stop immediately if significant pain or bleeding occurs.
- Use only the prescribed solution, concentration, volume, and administration rate; some solutions can cause serious electrolyte or fluid complications if misused.
- Use aseptic or clean technique according to the clinical protocol and never share single-use components between patients.
- Do not improvise tubing, connectors, or nozzle attachments, and never connect the kit to pressurised equipment.
- Seek urgent clinical help if severe pain, fainting, significant bleeding, breathing difficulty, or other serious symptoms occur.

Care & storage

- Check packaging integrity, expiry dates, and component condition before use.
- Store the kit and prescribed supplies according to the manufacturer's instructions and away from contamination.
- Discard single-use items after one use and dispose of clinical waste according to local procedures.
- Clean and disinfect reusable components only according to the manufacturer's validated instructions.

- Report damaged kits, missing components, or suspected contamination and replace them before use.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using an unprescribed solution, incorrect volume, or unsuitable temperature.
- Forcing the nozzle or increasing flow when resistance or pain occurs.
- Reusing single-use components or failing to maintain hygiene.
- Ignoring contraindications, warning symptoms, or unexpected patient reactions.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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